OPINION · TECHNOLOGY & JOURNALISM

I am a journalism student and I am not afraid of AI. Here is why

AI tools are now embedded in newsrooms around the world, and journalism students entering the industry are the first generation who will have to decide what responsible use actually looks like.

When I was a kid, my friends and I made short films on our iPods using iMovie. We even submitted one to a local film festival, which felt like a massive deal at the time. Every frame of those films was ours, made from our specific group of friends, our specific backyard, our specific idea of what was worth putting on camera. And now I am sitting in journalism school thinking about the fact that a machine can do what we did, only better, and somehow that fills me with amazement more than anything else.

AI is the most astonishing thing I have ever watched happen in real time and I think a lot of people my age feel the same way even if they would never admit it out loud. If you told me as a kid that a machine would one day write news articles, hold conversations that feel completely human, and generate photorealistic images from a single typed sentence, I would have thought you were describing a dystopian movie. But here we are, and I think the most honest and responsible thing a young journalist can do right now is stop pretending this technology is only something to be afraid of.

The fear is legitimate and I am not dismissing it. 73 percent of global news organizations have already adopted AI technology, and that number did not grow gradually. The proportion of people using standalone AI tools like ChatGPT jumped from 40 percent to 61 percent in a single year, according to the Reuters Institute's 2025 survey. People are moving faster than the rules that are supposed to govern any of this, and only 13 percent of newsrooms globally have a formal AI policy in place. That gap is where most of the damage is happening right now.

> ***AI is not the problem. Journalists who stop doing their job and let AI do it for them are the problem.***

But here is the thing people do not talk about enough: human journalists get things wrong all the time too. They carry biases they do not always catch, they work under deadlines that push them toward shortcuts, and they operate inside newsrooms that have been shrinking for years. Canada has lost more than 500 local news operations in the last 15 years, and reporters like Kieran Fong have written about covering entire towns alone on $42,000 a year until it broke them. Those communities are not getting their stories told. If AI can help one exhausted journalist cover a school board meeting or a city hall vote that would otherwise go unnoticed, then it is actually doing something journalism has always claimed to care about. In newsrooms across the Global South, more than 80 percent of journalists now use AI daily for drafting, transcription and research. These are not well-funded operations with large teams, these are people trying to cover their communities with almost nothing.

> ***We are living inside one of the most extraordinary technological moments in human history and you are allowed to be worried about it and amazed by it at the exact same time.***

That is genuinely where I have landed on this. Not naive, not panicked, just curious and paying close attention. When my friends and I were pointing iPods at each other in someone's backyard, the camera did not make the film. We did. The bad lighting was ours, the story was ours, and that meant something. Whatever AI becomes and however good it gets, I still believe the stories that actually matter to people will need a human being who cares enough to go find them. That job is not going anywhere. It is just going to look different, and different has always been the most interesting place to be.